

37.4 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTED SPEECH

In reported speech, the main verb often changes tense to a past form. You may also need to change a time or place reference.

I **don't** believe **these** ghost stories.



He said that he **didn't** believe **those** ghost stories.

"These" is replaced by the more distant "those."



In reported open questions, the subject comes before the verb and you don't use a question form.

What are you reading?



I asked her what she was reading.



In reported closed questions (with a "yes / no" answer), you use "if" or "whether."

Are you enjoying it?



I asked her { **if** / **whether** } she was enjoying it.



37.5 REWRITE THE SENTENCES USING REPORTED SPEECH

Amal has bought a book about ghosts.

Amal said that she had bought a book about ghosts.

① Amal's reading a scary story.

Amal mentioned _____

② Amal's finished the book.

Amal told me _____

③ Are you going to the movies?

I asked her _____

④ What kind of movie are you going to see?

I asked her _____

⑤ Did you enjoy it?

I asked her _____

